```
    public static class Decision {    #D
    }
}
```

#A Gather relevant attributes and group into categories.
#B Check whether the request is permitted.
#C If not then halt with a 403 Forbidden error.
#D The Decision class will be described next.

8.3.1 Combining decisions

When implementing ABAC, typically access control decisions are structured as a set of independent rules describing whether a request should be permitted or denied. If more than one rule matches a request, and they have different outcomes, then the question is which one should be preferred. This boils down to the two following questions:

- What should the default decision be if no access control rules match the request?
- How should conflicting decisions be resolved?

The safest option is to default to denying requests unless explicitly permitted by some access rule, and to give deny decisions priority over permit decisions. This requires at least one rule to match and decide to permit the action and no rules to decide to deny the action for the request to be allowed. When adding ABAC on top of an existing access control system to enforce additional constraints that cannot be expressed in the existing system, it can be simpler to